

Acme Corp Employee Handbook

Effective Date: January 2026

1. Vacation Policy

Full-time employees accrue 15 paid vacation days per calendar year, accrued at a rate of 1.25 days per month. Vacation requests must be submitted to a manager at least 10 business days in advance for approval. Unused vacation days may be carried over into the next calendar year up to a maximum of 5 days; any balance beyond that is forfeited on December 31st. Part-time employees accrue vacation on a pro-rated basis according to their scheduled hours.

2. Sick Leave Policy

Employees are entitled to 10 paid sick days per year, which do not carry over to the following year. Employees must notify their direct manager before the start of their shift if they are unable to work due to illness. A doctor's note is required for any sick leave exceeding 3 consecutive days. Sick leave may also be used to care for an immediate family member under the company's Family Care provision.

3. Remote Work Policy

Employees may work remotely up to 3 days per week with manager approval, provided their role is designated as remote-eligible. Remote work arrangements must be reviewed and re-approved quarterly. Employees working remotely are expected to be available during core hours of 10 AM to 3 PM in their local time zone and must maintain a stable internet connection. The company will provide a one-time home office stipend of \$300 for eligible remote employees.

4. Code of Conduct

All employees are expected to act with integrity, respect, and professionalism in all workplace interactions, whether in person, virtual, or written communication. Harassment, discrimination, or retaliation of any kind will not be tolerated and should be reported immediately to HR or through the anonymous ethics hotline. Violations of the Code of Conduct may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment.

5. Expense Reimbursement Policy

Business-related expenses must be submitted through the expense portal within 30 days of the purchase date, accompanied by an itemized receipt. Expenses exceeding \$500 require pre-approval from a department head before being incurred. Reimbursable categories include travel, client meals (up to \$75 per person), and approved software subscriptions. Reimbursements are processed within 10 business days of approval.

6. Performance Review Process

Formal performance reviews are conducted twice annually, in June and December. Reviews are based on goal completion, peer feedback, and manager assessment using the company's competency framework. Employees receive a written summary and a rating on a 5-point scale. Ratings of 4 or above are eligible for the annual merit increase cycle, subject to budget approval. New employees receive an informal 90-day check-in in addition to the standard review cycle.

7. Termination and Resignation Policy

Employees who wish to resign are asked to provide a minimum of 2 weeks' written notice to their manager and HR. The company reserves the right to terminate employment at any time, with or without cause, in accordance with applicable employment standards legislation. Final pay, including any accrued and unused vacation pay, will be issued within the timeframe required by provincial employment law. Exit interviews are conducted for all departing employees.